

NIKI KHANEZAI

London SW, Greater London, Wandsworth SW18 4PS

+447562738553 | nikikhanezai@gmail.com

Portfolio: <https://nkanzii.github.io/my-portfolio-website/> | GitHub: <https://github.com/Nkanzii>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/niki-khanezai/>

SUMMARY

Front-end developer and creative technologist with a strong foundation in JavaScript, generative art, 3D web, physical computing and game development. Builds expressive, technically ambitious digital experiences — from live data visualisations and Three.js 3D environments to Unity games with custom Arduino hardware controllers. Combines a background in illustration and animation with rigorous technical skills to produce work that is both visually distinctive and well-engineered.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Python	Creative & Design Tools Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Procreate, TouchDesigner
Frameworks & Libraries p5.js, Three.js, Unity Engine, Arduino Framework, ml5.js, Transformers (HuggingFace), PyTorch	Creative Tech Generative Art, Physical Computing, Sensor Integration (MPU-6050), Game Design, Interactive Installations, Emotion Classification, Generative Image Synthesis
Web & Dev Tools Git, GitHub, VS Code, Arduino IDE, Chrome DevTools, Figma DOM Manipulation, REST APIs, Fetch API, JSON, Responsive Design, CSS Animation, Serial Communication, Jupyter Notebooks, NewsAPI	Soft Skills Team Leadership, Communication, Problem Solving, Initiative, Attention to Detail, Time Management

PROJECTS

Habit Game — Unity & Python - Built a voice-driven habit tracking game in Unity (C#) where a 3D world and robot companion visually shift between healthy, neutral and decaying states based on daily consistency - Engineered a streak system using date-based PlayerPrefs logic and a Python TCP socket pipeline (sounddevice, SpeechRecognition) as a Mac-compatible alternative to Windows-only Unity speech APIs - Architected a modular multi-script system (GameManager, StreakManager, VoiceListener, WorldStateManager, RobotController) with dynamic lighting, skybox transitions and Mixamo character animation	Who Defines Truth? — Three.js - Immersive 3D web experience built with Three.js exploring themes of faith and power — a veiled figure surrounded by darkness, circled by animated light and rotating Arabic scripture - Implemented custom shaders, dynamic camera animation and atmospheric lighting to create a cinematic emotional mood - Deployed live on GitHub Pages with optimised asset loading and consistent frame performance
The News as a Nervous System — Python & Machine Learning - Built an end-to-end ML pipeline that fetches live news headlines via NewsAPI and classifies them for emotional content (fear, anger, sadness, joy) using a fine-tuned DistilBERT transformer model - Averaged emotion scores across headlines to generate a collective emotional state, which drives dynamic prompt generation for abstract image synthesis via Stable Diffusion - Critically engages AI as a reflective tool for communicating political trauma — grounded in Caramiaux & Fdili Alaoui's framework for AI practice in visual arts	p5.js Creative Coding Gallery - Six live interactive sketches including a NASA Asteroid API visualisation fetching real data to render hazardous vs non-hazardous asteroids as animated orbiting bodies - Real-time ASCII image animation using pixel-mapped character rendering; rotating Persian calligraphy piece with a Rumi quote spiralling in layered rings via p5.js text rendering - Recursive fractal circle branching with Perlin noise and a generative character expression system with mouse-tracking eyes, all embedded live in a custom-built portfolio site
Tetris Remake — Unity & Arduino - Rebuilt Tetris from scratch in Unity (C#) with full game logic — line clearing, scoring, speed progression and game state management - Designed and built a custom physical controller using Arduino: an MPU-6050 tilt sensor controls block rotation by physically tilting the device, with hardware buttons for left/right movement and hard drop - Programmed serial communication between Arduino and Unity to handle real-time sensor input at low latency, bridging physical hardware with digital gameplay	Particle Weather — p5.js & Live API - Built a real-time generative art system that fetches live weather data from the Open-Meteo API and translates it into motion 800 particles orbit a canvas, speed driven by real wind velocity, colour shifting across six atmospheric states - Implemented data mapping, real-time render optimisation and API integration entirely self-directed

EXPERIENCE

Customer Trading Manager – Sainsbury's Local (2024–Present) - Led team operations, mentored new staff and managed complex customer queries - Developed scheduling and task delegation systems to maintain productivity during busy periods - Demonstrated leadership and independent problem-solving in a fast-paced environment	Sales Assistant – Sainsbury's Local (2021–2024) & Topshop (2020–2021) - Delivered consistent customer service and supported daily floor operations - Built teamwork and communication skills through collaboration during high-pressure periods - Handled tills, refunds and stock management independently and reliably
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EDUCATION

University of Arts London (2025–2026) MSc Creative Computing
Kingston University (2021–2024) BA Illustration Animation Final project focused on interactive animation and storytelling
Ravensbourne University London (2020–2021) Foundation Degree in Visual Communication

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Languages:** English, Farsi
- Certifications:** Meta Front-End Developer Certificate (JavaScript) – Coursera